



Samsung to stop Milk Music

Samsung is shutting down its streaming radio service, Milk Music
<http://dgit.in/mmstop>



Lyft looking for buyers

Lyft, a ride sharing service, is said to be in talks with Uber, but no deal yet
<http://dgit.in/lyftcarapp>

Work@tech

art and tech. Granted, one person can also make such a project, but it's better done with people who are specialists in their fields. So we need 3D artists to make the art and programmers to add interactivity and functionality. Creating high quality AR/VR experiences require carefully created and optimised art, and a good understanding of the human perception system as we are trying to fool the brain to think that it's looking at something that doesn't really exist. If I had to broadly classify the roles students can target to achieve,



CHANDAN SINGH
VR Head, SmartVizX

there will be three of them: artists, programmers and designers.”

Based on inputs from several industry experts, we can say that some of the significant roles in the VR-AR industry are as follows:

- 3D Artist – Content Coordinator
- Senior Technical Artist
- 3D Artist
- VR-AR Project Manager
- Account Manager
- Marketing Concept Artist
- Social Media Specialist
- Web Developer
- Unity Developer
- Software Engineer
- Interaction Designer
- Frontend/Backend developer
- Design technologist
- Graphic Designer
- VR Game designers
- Oculus developers
- VR/AR programmers
- Augmented reality app designers

- FX technical artists
- Gameplay engineers

Abhishek Gupta, Co-Founder and CEO, GreyKernel (a VR content outfit), puts forward an interesting way to decide which part of the VR development you can be a part of. “The choice effectively follows the life cycle where the first skill set needed is of a Storyboarding Artist - One who conceptualizes the entire script, story and requirement for end visualization. Then on the basis of the input received, a 3D artist would design the environment, characters, assets required for the experience. Lastly, once the 3D environment is ready a VR Programmer would utilize the 3D environment to prepare the VR/AR experience basis the need of the story”. He adds, “Although every role for VR/AR is equally important/in-demand, but still students from different streams/qualifications could try leveraging their interests to find a suitable career in VR industry. All the creative content writers with a great sense of scene building and strong photographic imagination usually fits well for role of the Storyboarding Artist. Creative Designers/Developers having decent understanding about the global art building/styles should aspire for a role of 3D Artist. Just in case you have a strong affinity towards gaming and logical programming at the same time, VR Developer is the role for you.”

The training

Once you have a role in mind, or even a general area within VR and AR where you would like to work, it's always better to start preparing early for it. As Mr. Sushant Baliga, CEO, SpectraVR explains, “India is an opportunistic ground for the AR and VR technology. However, the same is at a very nascent stage, especially in the educational department. There are universities abroad that provide short courses in the same like the Stanford University, but those are also at a very preliminary stage.” He further adds, “Developers largely include 3D artists, Unity managers, programmers, game developers, and app developers. Non-developers

include cinematic VR creation, i.e. camera knowledge, shooting techniques, planning, project management, business analysts and more. Though the best way to get yourself savvy is self-learning. Keep oneself updated on the latest VR trends, follow VR blogs, forums, attend webinars, conferences, go through YouTube videos and get some hands-on experience.”

It is true that resources and actual courses in India are quite scarce now. There are some international universities that do offer courses. University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign has a course, CS:498, dedicated to understanding the fundamentals of VR and providing practical experience to students so that they can learn how to create better VR content. Deakin University from Australia also has a dedicated VR Lab, which makes it a good destination for studying VR. Apart from these, there are quite a few online courses available. Layout VR is a provider of one such introductory course that focuses on enabling you to develop content for Oculus and Vive using the Unreal Engine 4. Also, Udemy has a large number of courses



ABHISHEK GUPTA
Co-Founder and CEO,
GreyKernel

on this topic, with specialisations ranging from creating virtual reality movies to converting your existing 3D projects to VR. The prices on Udemy range from free to up to \$50, so give the free ones a shot before you pay for the course of your choice. On the Aug-